

PATNA INITIATIVE

Professional African Technical Network Advisory

Data Strategy Documentation

Step 6: Crafting the Data Vision

Where is PATNA heading — and what will be different when it gets there?

The North Star that makes every data decision obvious.

Framework: 6-Step Data Strategy Roadmap | Completes the six-step journey | March 2026

"A good data vision doesn't describe technology. It describes how decisions, behaviour, and outcomes change."

This document synthesises everything PATNA has learned across five steps into one coherent direction — and holds that direction to account through explicit boundaries, a phased roadmap, and AI usage principles.

PART ONE

What the Journey Has Taught Us

Synthesis Across All Five Steps

Before articulating the vision, it is worth being explicit about what the five preceding steps have revealed. The data vision is not invented — it emerges from the evidence of the steps that precede it. A vision built on shaky foundations will drift. This one is grounded.

Step	What It Revealed	What It Demands of the Vision
Step 0: Value Proposition	Two distinct value propositions: organisational (coordination, evidence, decision intelligence for Africa's energy transition) and platform (governed community and knowledge system). Technology serves both but equals neither.	The vision must be grounded in what PATNA promises people and the planet — not in what technology it can build.
Step 1: Business Model	PATNA is a non-profit coordination platform operating through human relationships, expert knowledge, and convening power. Revenue is grant-based and mission-constrained. Impact is real but diffuse.	The vision must respect that PATNA's model is relationship-first and that data serves — rather than replaces — the human judgment at the centre of its work.
Step 2: KPI Mapping	Every part of the business model has measurable health indicators. The most critical are the VP KPIs: coordinated community engagement, knowledge uptake, and policy influence. None of these are currently measured.	The vision must commit to making VP KPIs operational — not as aspirations but as live data that informs real decisions on a regular cadence.
Step 3: Maturity Assessment	Technology and Governance are at Level 1 — Initial. People & Culture and Strategy & Impact are at Level 2. The organisation is capable of doing real work without data infrastructure — but cannot scale, improve, or prove impact without it.	The vision must be honest about the starting point. It cannot target Level 4 capabilities on Level 1 infrastructure. The next step is Level 2–3, not Level 5.
Step 4: Lifecycle Mapping	Data breaks down at almost every stage across all three VP delivery flows. Storage is fragmented. Preparation is absent. Learning is entirely missing. The Learn stage — the feedback loop that makes PATNA better — does not exist in any of the three critical flows.	The vision must prioritise the completion of the data lifecycle — especially the Learn stage — over the addition of new data collection points. Closing loops matters more than opening new ones.
Step 5: VP Mapping	Five initiatives are worth building, in a specific sequence. I-1 and I-2 are foundational and non-negotiable. I-3 requires a methodology as much as a technology. I-4 and I-5 are Phase 2 and depend on data flowing from the first three.	The vision must reflect the sequencing logic. It is not about building everything — it is about building in the right order so that each initiative creates the conditions for the next.

The Synthesis in One Sentence

PATNA is doing real, valuable work for Africa's energy transition — but cannot yet prove it, improve it systematically, or scale it with confidence. The data strategy changes that, one governed step at a time.

PART TWO

The Four Components of the Data Vision

A strong data vision answers four questions: where are we going next? what will change in how decisions are made? what value will this unlock? and what are we explicitly not doing? Each component is developed here before being synthesised into the vision statement.

Component 1: Maturity Target

The maturity target is not the ultimate destination — it is the next realistic step. Attempting to describe the Level 5 end state before achieving Level 3 foundations creates visions that inspire and then disappoint. The target below is anchored in Step 3's assessment and Step 5's initiative sequencing.

1

Maturity Target

Starting Point (March 2026):

People & Culture: Level 2 — Managed. Processes: Level 1.5 — Initial to Managed. Technology: Level 1 — Initial. Governance: Level 1 — Initial. Strategy & Impact: Level 2 — Managed. Limiting pillars: Technology and Governance (co-equal constraints).

12-Month Target (March 2027):

Technology: Level 3 — Defined (platform MVP live; member database, Insights Hub, community spaces all operational; analytics active). Governance: Level 2 — Managed (taxonomy agreed; data owners named; privacy framework published; attribution methodology documented). Processes: Level 2–3 — Managed to Defined (onboarding, publishing, and engagement workflows systematised by the platform). People & Culture: Level 3 — Defined (VP KPI review cadence established; team reviewing evidence monthly; data champions named in Secretariat and cohort leads). Strategy & Impact: Level 3 — Defined (VP KPIs operational; Theory of Change verifiable with real data; funder reporting rebuilt from platform data).

24-Month Horizon (March 2028):

Technology: Level 4 — Integrated (AI layer live and grounded; analytics cross-system; policy influence dashboard operational). Governance: Level 3 — Defined (governance framework documented, monitored, and enforced). Strategy & Impact: Level 4 — Integrated (longitudinal effectiveness tracking; outcome-based funder reporting; PATNA making specific, data-backed impact claims about policy influence).

Component 2: Decision Change

This is the heart of the vision. The question is not 'what technology will we build?' but 'which decisions will be made differently — by specific people — because of what we're building?' The following captures the three most consequential decision changes PATNA's data strategy creates.

2

Decision Change

Decision Change A — Community Strategy:

Today: Secretariat decides who to recruit, which cohorts to invest in, and whether the community is healthy based on personal impression and email traffic. After: Secretariat reviews community health data monthly — active members by cohort, onboarding conversion rate, geographic representation, engagement depth — and makes targeted recruitment and re-engagement decisions based on evidence of what is and isn't working.

Decision Change B — Knowledge Production:

Today: Content is produced reactively, when someone has time and something to say. There is no view of what the knowledge base covers, what it misses, or when practitioners need it most. After: A quarterly editorial planning session reviews the policy process calendar against the current knowledge inventory, identifies gaps, and commissions content to fill them before the session where it is needed. Publishing decisions are informed by uptake data — what is being read, by whom, and where more is needed.

Decision Change C — Policy Engagement:

Today: PATNA cannot tell whether its policy work — convenings, briefs, member participation in IMO and UNFCCC sessions — is changing anything. Decisions about which processes to prioritise are based on relationships and intuition. After: A post-process debrief cycle reviews participation data, position language, and outcome text for each major session. The next year's engagement strategy is updated based on what the evidence shows worked and what did not. For the first time, PATNA can say: this approach improved African position quality; this one did not justify the investment.

Before and After: The Human Change at the Centre

Before (Today)	After (Vision Achieved)	How Data Makes This Possible
Before: - Secretariat makes strategic decisions from memory and instinct - Funder reports assembled retrospectively from emails and notes - Community health assessed by feeling, not data - Knowledge production follows availability, not need	After: - Secretariat reviews VP KPIs monthly; decisions grounded in evidence - Funder reports generated from platform data; outcome-based - Community health monitored in real time; interventions data-triggered - Knowledge produced to a calendar aligned with process needs	How data makes this possible: - Member database + engagement analytics (I-1) - Impact dashboard synthesising all three VP pillars (I-4) - Cohort health monitoring + retention tracking (I-1) - Insights Hub analytics + editorial calendar (I-2) - Policy influence tracker + attribution methodology (I-3)

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|--|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Policy influence claimed through narrative vignettes, not evidence | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Policy influence tracked and compared across successive cycles | |
|--|--|--|

Component 3: Value Realisation

Decision changes create value. The following connects each decision change to its tangible outcomes across the three dimensions that justify PATNA's existence.

3 Value Realisation

For People — African Experts and Decision-Makers:

African negotiators and policymakers supported by PATNA will enter successive IMO and UNFCCC sessions better prepared, with more consistent peer support, and with clearer access to the evidence needed to build technically credible positions. Over successive process cycles, the quality of Africa's technical participation will demonstrably improve — visible in the depth of submissions, the coherence of the Africa Group position, and the confidence of individual delegates who can point to PATNA's knowledge base as a preparation resource.

For the Planet — Climate and Decarbonisation Outcomes:

Better-prepared, more coherent African positions in IMO and UNFCCC processes mean that the frameworks shaping global decarbonisation — the GHG Fuel Standard, mid-term levy design, NDC ambition, Just Transition mechanisms — are designed with African realities more explicitly in view. PATNA's contribution is not to 'save the planet' but to improve the quality of the global agreements that govern how decarbonisation happens — and whether it happens justly. That is a specific, defensible, and meaningful contribution to planetary outcomes.

For PATNA's Sustainability — Organisational and Financial:

An organisation that can measure its impact can report it credibly, attract higher-value funders, and command programme-level investment rather than project grants. The data infrastructure being built is not just a measurement system — it is a credibility system. Each initiative that goes live, and each cycle of data that accumulates, builds the evidence base that makes PATNA a more investable institution. Advisory services revenue becomes viable when PATNA can demonstrate a track record of influence, not just a history of events.

Component 4: Scope & Boundaries

The most underrated component of a data vision. Clear boundaries are not admissions of weakness — they are evidence of discipline. They protect against scope creep, prevent AI hype from distorting priorities, and build trust with funders and partners who need to know what PATNA will and won't do with data.

4

Boundaries

What PATNA is explicitly committing to:

Building a governed, structured community and knowledge platform that makes the coordination, evidence, and decision intelligence promises measurable and deliverable. Measuring what matters for the VP promise — not tracking everything that can be tracked. Making one maturity level of progress at a time, with governance decisions preceding technology decisions at every step. Using AI only after the knowledge foundation it requires is in place.

What PATNA is explicitly not doing (yet):

PATNA is not building a general-purpose data platform. It is not attempting to automate strategic decisions. It is not claiming direct attribution for changes in IMO or UNFCCC outcomes — only contribution. It is not deploying AI before its knowledge base is structured and its governance framework is operational. It is not building for Level 4 capabilities on Level 1 infrastructure.

What PATNA WILL do	What PATNA will NOT do (yet)	Why this boundary matters
Measure VP KPI delivery across three pillars on a regular cadence	Track every possible metric from the platform	Vanity metrics distract from the handful that matter. Every metric must answer a business question or it doesn't belong.
Build the platform in phases, starting with foundation (I-1, I-2)	Build all five initiatives simultaneously	Simultaneous build creates ungoverned data and systems that don't connect. Sequential build ensures each initiative creates conditions for the next.
Make contribution claims about policy influence — specific, bounded, and traceable	Claim sole causation for changes in international frameworks	PATNA improves the quality of African inputs to global processes. It does not control global process outputs. Attribution must be honest.
Deploy AI (RAG) after the Insights Hub is tagged, indexed, and quality-reviewed	Deploy AI before the knowledge base it reasons about is structured	An AI over unstructured content hallucinates. An AI over governed, tagged, PATNA-reviewed content augments. The difference is the prerequisite.
Establish a governance framework before platform launch — taxonomy, owners, definitions, privacy	Govern data reactively, adding rules after problems emerge	Governance baked in before launch is infinitely easier than governance retrofitted after data has accumulated without standards.
Use data to inform and improve human judgment — convening, editorial, policy engagement decisions	Use data to replace human judgment in relationship-driven decisions	PATNA's core value is human expertise, trust, and coordination. Data augments this; it does not substitute for it.

PART THREE

The PATNA Data Vision Statement

The Vision Statement

The four components are now synthesised into a single statement. This is not a tagline — it is a working document that will be referenced in every platform design decision, every initiative prioritisation conversation, and every funder conversation about impact.

PATNA DATA VISION STATEMENT

We aim to make PATNA's three-pillar impact promise measurable and improvable — by building a governed community platform and knowledge system that makes our coordination visible, our evidence findable, and our policy influence traceable — so that Africa's participation in global energy transition and climate governance decisions demonstrably strengthens over successive process cycles — without replacing human judgment with technology, without claiming what the data cannot prove, and without building capabilities we are not yet ready to govern.

Reading the Vision Statement

Every clause of this statement carries deliberate weight:

Clause	Meaning	What It Rules Out
'measurable and improvable'	The goal is not dashboards — it is the feedback loop that makes PATNA better. Measurement exists to drive improvement, not to satisfy reporting requirements.	Vanity metrics. Measurement that is reported but never acted upon.
'governed community platform and knowledge system'	Technology is named second, governance first. The platform is only valuable if it is governed — with data owners, definitions, taxonomy, and privacy protections in place.	Ungoverned technology. Platforms built before governance decisions are made.
'coordination visible, evidence findable, policy influence traceable'	The three VP pillars are the measure of success. Not page views, not user counts — the three specific promises PATNA made about what it does for Africa.	Proxy metrics that look good but don't connect to the impact promise.

'demonstrably strengthens over successive process cycles'	Longitudinal improvement is the goal, not a one-time snapshot. PATNA's value is cumulative — building expertise, relationships, and institutional memory over successive IMO and UNFCCC cycles.	One-off impact claims. Snapshot evidence that cannot demonstrate trend.
'without replacing human judgment'	PATNA's core asset is the expertise, trust, and relationships of its community. Data augments this; it does not substitute for it.	Over-automation. AI that makes decisions rather than informing them.
'without claiming what the data cannot prove'	Attribution integrity is a principle, not just a methodological footnote. PATNA will claim contribution, not causation.	Overstated impact claims that damage credibility when challenged.
'without building capabilities we are not yet ready to govern'	Maturity-respecting design. No Level 4 technology on Level 1 governance. Each phase builds on what the previous phase has established.	Premature AI deployment. Data warehouses built before data quality standards exist.

Vision Validation Checks

The vision statement is tested against the five checks from the 6-Step framework:

Vision Validation Test		Verdict
Could a non-technical leader understand this vision?	✓	Yes. It describes what changes for Africa — not what technology is built. No technical jargon required to parse it.
Does this feel achievable given PATNA's current maturity (average Level 1.5–2)?	✓	Yes. The 12-month target (Level 2–3) is realistic given the platform build. The vision does not claim Level 5 transformation.
Would this help PATNA say no to bad ideas?	✓	Yes. Any initiative that cannot be connected to coordination visibility, evidence findability, or policy influence traceability fails the filter. Any AI initiative that precedes I-2 fails the governance prerequisite test.
Does it clearly link to business value?	✓	Yes. Demonstrably stronger African participation is the business value — for members, for funders, and for PATNA's organisational sustainability.
Does it respect human judgment?	✓	Yes. 'Without replacing human judgment' is explicit. Data augments; it does not replace the expertise that makes PATNA valuable.

PART FOUR

Implementation Roadmap

Phased Delivery — From Vision to Action

A vision without a sequenced implementation plan is aspiration, not strategy. The following roadmap connects the five initiatives from Step 5 to the four maturity components, across four phases with explicit capability milestones.

Phase	Timeframe	Initiatives	Capability Unlocked	VP Pillar Advanced
Phase 0 Governance Sprint Weeks 1–4	Concurrent with platform build	Content taxonomy designed and agreed. Data owner roles assigned. KPI definitions formalised. Privacy framework published. Attribution methodology drafted. AI usage principles documented.	No data collection begins without governance. Taxonomy fixed before first piece of content is tagged. Privacy framework in place before first member data is stored.	All three — prerequisites to measurement
Phase 1 Platform MVP Months 1–2	I-1 + I-2 + I-3 participation registry	Member database live. Onboarding workflow operational. Community spaces available. Insights Hub with taxonomy and search live. Content analytics active. Process participation registry open.	Coordination and Evidence VP pillars begin generating data for the first time. Community health becomes measurable. Knowledge reach becomes trackable. Policy participation becomes a record.	Coordination + Evidence (both begin)
Phase 2 Analytics & AI Months 3–6	I-3 full + I-4 + I-5	Policy influence tracking dashboard live. Post-process debrief cycle established. Impact dashboard synthesising all three pillars. AI RAG layer live and grounded in Insights Hub content. Monthly VP KPI review cadence established.	Decision intelligence VP pillar becomes measurable. Leadership has a unified view of organisational health. AI augments member preparation. Funder reporting rebuilt from data.	Decision Intelligence (begins) All three — integrated view
Phase 3 Learning Systems Months 7–18	All initiatives — learning loops	Longitudinal tracking across IMO/UNFCCC process cycles. Cohort health trend analysis. Knowledge gap analysis vs. policy calendar. Post-process debrief feeding editorial planning. Annual strategy update grounded in evidence.	PATNA begins to improve its effectiveness based on evidence of what worked. The feedback loop — the Learn stage — closes across all three lifecycle flows. The decision intelligence promise	All three — improvement over time

		becomes demonstrably operational.	
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AI Usage Principles

PATNA is committed to responsible AI. These principles operationalise that commitment — not as a constraint on ambition but as the architecture of trust that makes AI useful rather than risky in an organisation whose value is built on credibility.

Principle	What It Means for PATNA	What It Rules Out
Human-first design	AI augments, never replaces, the human judgment at the centre of PATNA's work. Every AI output requires a human to decide what to do with it.	Fully automated decisions about community membership, content publication, or policy positions — these remain human decisions.
Grounded knowledge only	The PATNA AI layer reasons exclusively about PATNA-curated, PATNA-approved content. It does not retrieve from the open web. It does not generate content PATNA has not reviewed.	AI that answers questions about topics outside PATNA's knowledge base, or that fabricates citations, or that presents external content as PATNA's own.
Source citation mandatory	Every AI response must cite the specific PATNA content it is drawing from. Users must be able to verify the source.	Black-box AI responses that cannot be traced to source material. Users must always know where an answer came from.
Maturity-gated deployment	The AI layer is not deployed until I-2 (Insights Hub) is live, tagged, quality-reviewed, and has a minimum viable knowledge base. This is non-negotiable.	Deploying AI before the knowledge base is structured. The quality of the AI's output is directly determined by the quality of what it reasons about.
Transparent to users	All members interacting with the AI layer are clearly informed that they are interacting with an AI grounded in PATNA's knowledge base — not a human expert and not a general-purpose AI.	Ambiguity about whether a user is interacting with a human or AI. Misrepresentation of the AI's scope or authority.
Continuous review	The Secretariat reviews AI query logs and response quality regularly. Known errors are corrected. Systematic gaps discovered through query logs feed editorial planning.	Set-and-forget AI deployment. AI systems drift in quality without ongoing human review and correction.

Governance Model Outline

The governance framework makes the vision governable. The following outlines the minimum governance architecture required before the platform goes live.

Governance Area	Decisions Required Before Launch	Owner	Review Cadence
Data Ownership	Named data owner for: member database; content taxonomy; policy influence records; analytics data	Secretariat Admin (platform); Cohort Leads (cohort data)	Annual review; ad-hoc on role change
KPI Definitions	Agreed operational definitions for: 'active member'; 'knowledge uptake'; 'policy influence contribution'; 'coordination evidence'	Secretariat Lead	Annual; updated if business model changes
Content Taxonomy	Full tag vocabulary agreed: theme, geography, constituency, process, content type; tagging rules documented; responsibility assigned	Content Editor + Secretariat Admin	Quarterly review; new tags require approval
Privacy Framework	GDPR-aligned privacy notice for member data; data retention periods set; member data access rights documented; data deletion process defined	Secretariat Admin	Annual audit; triggered by incidents
Attribution Methodology	Operational definition of 'policy influence'; evidence levels (direct, contribution, enabling); language comparison method; survey instrument for member-reported influence	Secretariat Lead + named Policy Influence Lead	After each major process cycle
AI Usage Principles	Formal adoption of the six AI usage principles; user-facing disclosure language for AI interactions; error reporting process; quarterly AI quality review process	Secretariat Admin + AI governance lead	Quarterly review of AI quality; annual principles review
Publishing Approval	Approval workflow for public content: draft → content editor review → Secretariat Admin approval → publish; cohort-relevant tagging by Cohort Leads before publication	Secretariat Admin	N/A — process; reviewed if bottlenecks emerge

Success Metrics for the Vision Itself

How will PATNA know in 12 months that the vision is being executed, not just articulated? The following metrics apply specifically to the data strategy implementation — tracking whether the strategy is working, not just whether the initiatives were built.

Success Metric	Measurement Method	Target (12 Months)	What Failure Looks Like
VP KPIs are operational and reviewed monthly	VP KPI review meeting minutes; dashboard active	All three VP pillar KPIs have real data; monthly review	KPIs defined but not reviewed; dashboard

		cadence established by Month 3	built but not used in decisions
Governance sprint completed before platform launch	Governance sprint outputs: taxonomy, ownership, privacy framework, attribution methodology all documented	All governance decisions documented before platform user-1 onboards	Platform live before governance complete; retroactive governance required
Data lifecycle closed in Flow 1 (Coordination)	Community health dashboard active; Learn stage: cohort review cadence established	Monthly cohort health review by Month 4; at least one re-engagement intervention triggered by data in first 6 months	Member data captured but not reviewed; no cohort health action taken from data
Data lifecycle closed in Flow 2 (Evidence)	Content analytics active; editorial calendar linked to process calendar	First process-calendar-aligned editorial plan produced by Month 3; content reach data reviewed in editorial meetings	Content published without analytics; editorial decisions not informed by uptake data
Policy influence methodology in use	Attribution methodology documented and applied to first process cycle	First post-process debrief completed with position tracking template by Month 6	Process cycle passes without structured debrief or position tracking
AI deployed on sound knowledge foundations	I-2 taxonomy completeness score; minimum content items indexed before AI launch	AI layer not deployed until: Insights Hub has 50+ tagged items; taxonomy completeness >90%; quality review complete	AI deployed on unstructured content; users receive hallucinated or poorly-sourced responses

CLOSING

From Strategy to Practice

What the Six Steps Have Built

Six steps, five documents, one coherent direction. The data strategy that PATNA now holds is not a technology plan — it is a commitment to accountability. A commitment to knowing whether the coordination, evidence, and decision intelligence promises are being kept. A commitment to improving what the evidence reveals is not working. And a commitment to telling the story of Africa's energy transition contributions with data rather than aspiration.

Step	Document	Key Output	Status
Step 0 + 1 + 2	Data Strategy Steps 0–2	Value Proposition Canvases; Business Model Canvas; KPI Inventory across 9 model blocks	Complete
Step 3	Data Maturity Assessment	5-pillar maturity baseline; VP KPI readiness review; Theory of Change; 3Ps and global goals mapping	Complete
Step 4	Data Lifecycle Mapping	3 critical lifecycle maps; policy calendar integration; IMO/UNFCCC contribution chain; 12-gap priority register	Complete
Step 5	Value Proposition Mapping	5 initiative canvases with full VP analysis, safety checks, and prioritisation matrix	Complete
Step 6	Data Vision (this document)	Vision statement; 4 components; phased roadmap; AI usage principles; governance model; success metrics	Complete

What Comes Next

The data strategy is now complete as a foundational document. What follows is execution — and execution requires three things that the strategy has deliberately not prescribed: the specific platform technology choices, the detailed sprint plans for the governance work, and the people decisions about who owns each data role.

Those decisions belong to PATNA's team. The strategy has given them a framework, a filter, and a direction. It has told them what to build in what order and why. It has told them what not to build and when. It has given them the questions to ask when a new initiative is proposed: does this serve a named customer with a real problem? does it connect to coordination, evidence, or decision intelligence? does it fit our current maturity? and does it respect the boundaries we have set?

The North Star

Every data decision PATNA makes from this point — what to build, what to measure, what to claim, what to defer — should be evaluated against the vision statement. If a decision makes the vision more achievable, it is probably right. If it makes the vision harder to achieve, or if it cannot be connected to the vision at all, it probably should not be prioritised.

THE
COMPLETE
DATA
STRATEGY

Step 0: Value Proposition → Step 1: Business Model → Step 2: KPI Mapping →
Step 3: Maturity Assessment → Step 4: Lifecycle Mapping → Step 5: VP Mapping
→ Step 6: Data Vision

**Africa's energy transition, governed by evidence, improved by data,
powered by human expertise.**